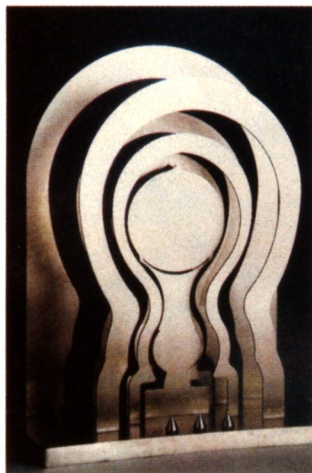


### art

## Sans Frontiers

**DELHI** As Indian art acquires global recognition and value, it is not surprising that the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) finds it a useful creative tool in furthering diplomatic relations with both, countries of the South Asian region and beyond.

External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee inaugurates an exhibition of works by 25 artists from SAARC countries at the Rabindra Bhavan in Delhi on June 2. Conceived and organised by the Indian **Kannati Bimbam**, a sculpture by Balan Nambiar in 25 Contemporary Indian Artists exhibition in Moscow



Nepal in Jaisalmer, Upadhyay's work for the SAARC camp



Council for Cultural Relations (ICCR) and the cultural organisation seher, the exhibition showcases works by artists at a specially organised camp in the desert city of Jaisalmer. Titled Jaisalmer Yellow, the show will be on view till June 4.

Also, to mark the 60th anniversary of Indo-Russian relations, the Indian embassy in Moscow unveiled on May 22 a major Indian contemporary art exhibition in collaboration with the Russian Academy of Arts. Believed to be for the first time ever, this exhibition, too, has 25 artists albeit all from India this time. Curated by Ravi Kumar, the gallerist-cum-publisher who has for long made Paris his home, the list of artists comprises both the old and the young, from S.H. Raza, Rajendra Dhawan and Sohan Qadri to Yusuf, Anwar and Debesh Goswami.

By getting French critic Nicolas Bourriaud to write an essay introducing the show in a handsome catalogue, the organisers have pulled a punch that is bound to impress the Russians. On till June 17.

by S. Kaildas

### film festival

## Water World

**BANGALORE** Arghyam, Bangalore Film Society and Films for Freedom in collaboration with Water Journeys-Forum for the Fundamental Right to Water, Finger Lakes Environmental Film Festival, Ithaca College and Urban Research Centre present the second international film festival Voices from the Water 2007. A celebration of "water", it features an exciting line-up of films like Satyajit Ray's *Ganashatru*, Girish Kasaravalli's *Dweepa*, M.S. Sathyu's *Bara*, early documentaries by Jahnu Barua and Ariban Shyam Sharma and new works. The festival will serve as a "platform for voices from Bihar, Kerala, Rajasthan, Bengal and others to narrate testimonies from lives lived and spent in the name of water" say the organisers. The four-day festival will also feature interactive sessions between filmmakers and audiences apart from music, dance performances and poster exhibitions. Watch out for *The Never Never Water* by Alessandra Speciale from Brazil and *Water First* by Amy Hart. From June 7 at Guru Nanak Bhavan.

by Nirmala Ravindran

The festival showcases films and art related to water



### art

## Inspired by India

**MUMBAI** India Inspires explores the creativity of individuals inspired by India and attempts to reveal their thought processes, philosophies and personalities through their art. It showcases the works of prominent women artists Papri Bose, Prafulla Dhanukar, Shrilekha Sikander and Rohini Sinha, Fatima Ahmed, Anjani



A display at the exhibition Reddy, Meera Devidayal and Hema Joshi.

On till June 4 at Point of View Gallery.

by Swati Mathur